

SELLER RETENTION INTERVENTION PLAYBOOK

A step-by-step guide for the Seller Success Team

LR Model B | AUC-ROC 0.7643 | 3,806 Sellers | 3 Years of Platform Data

513

Persuadable Sellers

370

Requiring Active
Action

7

Behavioural Triggers

30.5%

Population Retention Rate

0.7643

Model AUC-ROC

01 Purpose and How to Use This Playbook

Supporting every seller with the same level of attention is an impossible task for the seller success team. The seller base is too large to invest equally across it. The decision of which sellers receive active support and which do not is therefore unavoidable. The problem is that this decision is usually made after a seller has already demonstrated commercial decline. This is too late in the sellers lifecycle because by the time poor performance is visible, the window where early support would have made a difference has already closed.

This playbook exists to bridge this gap. A machine learning model that was trained on three years of seller's data identifies which sellers are at risk of leaving in their first 60 days on the platform. This is only useful if it can be translated into action. This playbook translates the sellers risk scores from the model, segmentation matrix, and survival analysis triggers into a step by step instruction that tells the seller success team who to contact, when to act, and what to do.

The accompanying Power Bi dashboard makes those instructions operational in a live environment by giving the seller support team a daily action list, real time seller risk profiles, and trigger status for every Persuadable seller without the need to carry out any manual analysis.

Not every high risk seller is worth contacting. Ascarza (2018) demonstrates that some sellers at the top of the churn risk ranking have already decided to leave and will not respond to any intervention, while others would have stayed without any contact at all. Targeting on risk score alone wastes resources on sellers who cannot be saved and disturbs sellers who did not need help. The segmentation matrix in Section 3 directs the team toward sellers who are at risk and still reachable and not just those with the highest scores.

The playbook is organised into eight sections. Sections 2 and 3 cover the model score and introduces the segmentation matrix which tells the team which sellers to target. Section 4 covers the seven trigger thresholds and tells the team when to act across the three seller lifecycle stages. Section 5 covers how to use the dashboard day to day. Finally, Sections 6 provides recommended actions which tells the team what to do and how to communicate with the sellers.

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02 Churn Risk Score

How to read the model output

0 to 1 Score Range	0.5862 Population Median High / Low Risk Cut-off	0.80 Example: 80% probability of churn	0.20 Example: 20% probability of churn
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Every seller in the dataset has a churn risk score between 0 and 1 that tells the team how likely a seller is to leave in their first 12 months of activity on the platform. A score of 0.80 means that there is an 80% probability of churn. A score of 0.20 means that there is a 20% estimated probability of churn. The score is derived from behavioural signals observed in the first 60 days of a seller's tenure calculated on three years of this platform's data.

The median churn risk score across all sellers is 0.5862. Sellers that are above this threshold are classified as high risk and sellers below it are classified as low risk. It is used as the cut off point for classifying sellers as high risk or low risk in the segmentation matrix explained in Section 3.

The score tells you how likely this seller is to churn based on their early behaviour. It does not tell you why they are at risk or whether they will respond to any outreach from the seller support team. A seller with a score of 0.86 who is still logging in to the platform daily has a different behavior to that of a seller with the same score who has not been active in the last three weeks. The trigger system covered in Section 4 and the segmentation matrix in covered in Section 3 provides additional context that the score alone cannot provide.

03 The Segmentation Matrix

Who to target - 3,806 sellers across 4 segments

All 3,806 sellers are assigned into four groups on two axes in the segmentation matrix. The first axis is churn risk gotten from the model score described in Section 2. The second axis is an engagement indicator that was constructed from three behavioural signals observed in the early 60 day window. These include, login count, total session minutes, and days since last platform activity. Days since last activity is inverted so that a seller who was active recently scores high and one who has been inactive for a long time scores low to ensure that higher values always mean more engaged for all three signals. These signals were standardised and averaged to make up a single composite score. Sellers above the median engagement score are classified as high engagement and sellers below it are classified as low engagement. This median split is the same approach used to classify churn risk as mentioned in section 2.

When the two axes are combined, four segments emerge. These include high risk and high engagement, high risk and low engagement, low risk and high engagement, and low risk and low engagement. Each combination makes up a quadrant with its own name, retention rate, and recommended action for the seller support team to act on.

The rationale for using this two axis approach comes from Ascarza's (2018) finding that targeting sellers mainly on churn risk wastes resources on sellers who cannot be saved and disturbs sellers who did not need help. The likelihood of a seller leaving is not what matters but whether they are engaged enough to respond to any outreach. The engagement indicator acts as a measure of how reachable a seller is. A seller who is still logging in

regularly and was active on the platform recently is still reachable. A seller who hasn't logged in recently and has not been active on the platform recently, can be assumed to be unreachable.

PERSUADABLES

HIGH RISK | HIGH ENGAGEMENT

513	13.5%	15.6%	22.5	169 mins	3 days
Sellers	of Population	Retention Rate	Avg Logins	Avg Session	Since Last Activity

Sellers in the high churn risk, high engagement segment are labelled Persuadables. These sellers have a high risk of leaving but are still actively present on the platform. They average 22.5 logins, 169 session minutes, and 3 days since their last activity within the 60 day observation window. Their retention rate of 15.6% is below the 30.5% population retention rate across all 3,806 sellers, but their continued presence on the platform means that any outreach has a realistic chance of keeping them on the platform past the 12 month mark. This is the primary group the seller support team needs to allocate a majority of time and resources to.

Recommended action: Direct outreach - primary intervention target. Majority of seller success time and resources directed here.

LOST CAUSES

HIGH RISK | LOW ENGAGEMENT

1,390	36.5%	9.9%	5.8	40 mins	16.9 days
Sellers	of Population	Retention Rate	Avg Logins	Avg Session	Since Last Activity

Sellers in the high churn risk, low engagement segment are labelled Lost Causes. These sellers can be said to have already disengaged. They average 5.8 logins, 40 session minutes, and 16.9 days since their last activity within the 60 day observation window. Most of them will not be active at 12 months. This level of disengagement means that any direct intervention is unlikely to change their engagement pattern. The recommended action for the seller success team is to trigger a single low cost automated message with no further resource being allocated to them beyond that.

Recommended action: Single automated message only - no further resource allocation beyond that.

SURE THINGS

LOW RISK | HIGH ENGAGEMENT

1,390	36.5%	53.7%	29	259 mins	2.7 days
Sellers	of Population	Retention Rate	Avg Logins	Avg Session	Since Last Activity

Sellers in the low churn risk, high engagement segment are labelled as Sure Things. These are the healthiest sellers in the population. They average 29 logins, 259 session minutes, and only 2.7 days since their last activity within the 60 day observation window. Their retention rate is well above the population retention rate across all 3,806 sellers. The seller support team do not need to take any action with this group. Contacting these sellers without a valid reason risks unsettling them given that they do not need any attention.

Recommended action: No action required - leave undisturbed. Do not initiate contact.

SLEEPING DOGS

LOW RISK | LOW ENGAGEMENT

513

Sellers

13.5%

of Population

38.6%

Retention Rate

Sellers in the low churn risk, low engagement segment are labelled as Sleeping Dogs. These sellers are not necessarily active but the model does not flag them as exit risks. They are likely sellers who engage seasonally or sellers with low volume transactions but with stable activity patterns. Their retention rate is above the population retention rate across all 3,806 sellers. The seller support team need to monitor this group passively however, contact does not need to be initiated.

Recommended action: Monitor only - do not initiate contact.

An important point to note is the inequality of the seller segment sizes. This behavior is expected because the two axes are not independent of each other. The data naturally forms two groups because sellers who are highly engaged are more likely to have a lower churn risk compared to sellers who are disengaged who tend to have a higher churn risk. The implication of this is that the primary targets (Persuadables) are made up of a small group of sellers that the team should be able to manage which makes a structured outreach possible. The 513 Persuadables represents a workload the seller success team can act on rather than overstretching the team across the entire seller population.

04 The Trigger System

When to act - 7 triggers across 3 lifecycle stages

The trigger system tells the seller support team when to carry out intervention measures. A seller's churn risk does not remain the same all through their tenure on the platform. It increases at specific moments such as when their momentum in the early period reduces or when activity suddenly drops after a period of consistent engagement. Survival analysis, which is a method that tells you how long sellers remain active and at what point the risk of exit is highest, confirms that sellers are more likely to exit at certain points in their tenure than others rather than dropping off at a consistent rate throughout (Fader et al., 2018; Kimitei et al., 2025). This method was used to identify seven triggers across three lifecycle stages, with each being derived from this platform's own three years of seller data rather than external benchmarks. Every retention rate figure below compares sellers who crossed a threshold against those who did not. The trigger system applies to the Persuadable sellers group to alert the support team on when to take action on sellers within the group.

EARLY TENURE Days 0 to 90 | 4 triggers | Highest risk period

The first 90 days are the highest risk period in a seller's lifecycle. In this period, sellers have not yet developed assets such as reviews or buyer relationships to keep them on the platform if things go wrong. The switching cost that would normally make leaving difficult has not yet developed. The survival analysis shows that hazard rate increases sharply between months three and four at 17.1% which means that early intervention has a large chance of changing the outcome in the period leading up to that sharp increase. There are four triggers that apply at this stage.

LOW LOGIN COUNT *Threshold: fewer than 8 logins by day 60***12.4%**

Retention below threshold

38.3%

Retention above threshold

A seller with less than 8 logins by day 60 has a retention rate of 12.4% compared to 38.3% for sellers who exceed this threshold. This type of seller has barely engaged with the platform since joining, as such, the recommended response should be for the seller support team to carry out an onboarding outreach, specifically to walk the seller through different platform tools and provide listing optimisation support.

RESPONSE: Onboarding outreach - walk the seller through platform tools and provide listing optimisation support.

LOW SESSION TIME *Threshold: fewer than 50 total session minutes by day 60***9.4%**

Retention below threshold

38.1%

Retention above threshold

A seller with less than 50 total session minutes by day 60 has a retention rate of 9.4% compared to 38.1% for sellers who exceed this threshold. The gap between sellers below this threshold and sellers above it is the widest out of all seven triggers. These sellers visit the platform but do not spend much time on it, which suggests that they are present on the platform without building the operational routines that predict long term retention. The recommended response for the seller support team is to carry out a feature adoption campaign that targets analytics, pricing tools, and inventory management.

RESPONSE: Feature adoption campaign targeting analytics, pricing tools, and inventory management.

LOW SECOND-MONTH ORDERS *Threshold: fewer than 4 orders between days 30 to 60***11.9%**

Retention below threshold

38.3%

Retention above threshold

A seller with less than 4 orders between days 30 to 60 has a retention rate of 11.9% compared to 38.3% for sellers who exceed this threshold. This trigger measures performance in the second month on the platform. A seller who generated some activity in their first month but shows reduced activity in their second month is showing early signs of failing before any real commercial momentum is gained. The most likely cause is that they have listings that are not converting due to issues such as too few images or their listings are overpriced compared to competitors. The recommended response by the seller support team is to carry out a listing quality review by checking images and pricing against category benchmarks.

RESPONSE: Listing quality review - check images and pricing against category benchmarks.

DISPUTE RAISED - STATUS: RED *Threshold: any dispute in first 60 days***15.4%**

Retention below threshold

32.2%

Retention above threshold

A seller with disputes in their first 60 days has a retention rate of 15.4% compared to 32.2% for sellers who exceed this threshold. A dispute at this stage is a problem because it comes before the seller has built up a performance history or reviews that can balance it out. New sellers don't necessarily know how to handle the platform's dispute process effectively, and without support they are likely to disengage instead of working through it. An unresolved dispute in the early period can damage the seller's score and reduce listing visibility. The recommended response by the seller support team is to carry out immediate dispute resolution support and make direct contact with the seller within 24 hours.

RESPONSE: Immediate dispute resolution support - direct contact within 24 hours. Do not delay.

MID TENURE Days 90 to 270 | 3 triggers | Engagement continuity

There are three triggers that apply in the mid tenure stage of the sellers lifecycle. A seller that has reached 90 days on the platform has passed that initial risk window. The assumption is that they have done enough to establish themselves on the platform thereby changing the focus from whether they are engaging to whether they are maintaining that engagement consistently. A seller who regularly logged into the platform for three months and then goes quiet is showing a different pattern to a seller who was never engaged in the first place as seen in the early tenure. The mid tenure triggers are designed to identify these type of patterns in seller behavior.

INACTIVITY - 7 DAYS *Threshold: 7 or more consecutive days inactive***19.5%**

Retention below threshold

36.9%

Retention above threshold

A seller who has been inactive for 7 or more days has a retention rate of 19.5% compared to 36.9% for sellers who exceed this threshold. Seven days of inactivity in the mid tenure is not necessarily alarming because a seller could be absent for a week due to situations such as travel which are unrelated to their intention to leave. This trigger is valuable because it gives the team an early opportunity to check in before the situation develops further. The recommended response by the seller support team is to send a re-engagement message to check in on the seller's experience on the platform.

RESPONSE: Re-engagement message - a brief check-in on the seller's experience. Light touch, not an escalation.

INACTIVITY - 14 DAYS *Threshold: 14 or more consecutive days inactive***12.9%**

Retention below threshold

34.7%

Retention above threshold

A seller who has been inactive for 14 or more days has a retention rate of 12.9% compared to 34.7% for sellers who exceed this threshold. A seller who has gone two weeks without logging in or processing orders can be said to have churned. The research on disengagement patterns shows that sellers do not usually leave all of a sudden. They gradually withdraw by first reducing how often they login, then they stop updating their listings and then they become completely quiet before formally exiting. At 14 days without activity, they are likely already in that withdrawal process. The longer the team waits to make contact, the harder it becomes to reverse the disengagement. The recommended response by the seller support team is to contact the seller directly by phone rather than an automated message.

RESPONSE: Direct contact by phone - not an automated message. Urgency required.

HIGH LOGISTICS FAULT RATE *Threshold: logistics fault rate above 0.124***20.2%**

Retention below threshold

41.2%

Retention above threshold

A seller with a logistics fault rate above 0.124 has a retention rate of 20.2% compared to 41.2% for sellers who exceed this threshold. This trigger needs to be carefully handled because in the Nigerian operating environment, a logistics failure is not always the seller's fault. The existence of poor roads, unreliable courier networks, and infrastructure gaps outside Lagos can lead to faults that have nothing to do with how the seller is running their business. When this trigger becomes active, the first step is to understand the source of the failures before taking action. The recommended response by the seller support team is a diagnostic review of why the fault happened and not a performance warning.

RESPONSE: Diagnostic review - understand the source of failures before acting. Not a performance warning.

ESTABLISHED TENURE Days 270 and above | 2 triggers

There are two triggers that apply in the established tenure stage of the sellers lifecycle.

An established seller who has been consistently active for nine months or more and then suddenly goes quiet for two weeks is showing a much more unusual pattern than a mid tenure seller going inactive for the same period. The difference between their prior behaviour and their current absence is a signal that something has changed. The recommended response by the seller support team is to urgently contact the seller.

A logistics fault rate above 0.124 should be responded to with the same diagnostic approach as mid tenure. At this stage, however, a seller who has had frequent faults despite prior platform experience needs a deeper conversation about whether operational support would help rather than a standard logistics review.

When multiple triggers become active at the same time

When a Persuadable seller has crossed more than one trigger, the following take priority.

1st	Dispute comes first. The retention differential is the largest of any trigger and the risk of immediate exit is highest. Contact within 24 hours regardless of what other triggers are also active.
2nd	Extended inactivity comes second. A seller who is both inactive and has operational problems is at greater risk of exit than when either signal is considered alone.
3rd	High logistics fault rate comes third. It is the trigger most likely to have a cause outside the seller's control.

05 Daily Workflow with the Dashboard

Command Centre, Watchlist, Triggers, Drill-Down

The Power BI Dashboard is the operational platform for this playbook. It has four pages with each designed for a specific purpose. The workflow below describes how to move through them as part of a daily routine. Every piece of information needed to act on this playbook is available in the dashboard.

Before navigating the dashboard, it is important to understand the traffic light system that runs through it. Every Persuadable seller is assigned one of four statuses based on their trigger profile. Red means that a dispute trigger is active or at least two triggers are active. Amber means that exactly one non-dispute trigger is active. Green means that no triggers have been crossed and Grey means that the seller is not a Persuadable and no action is required regardless of how many triggers show. These four statuses appear throughout the the different pages of the dashboard and they guide the team as they work through their daily action list.

Status	Rule	Action
 RED 147 sellers	Dispute trigger active, or 2 or more triggers crossed	Contact within 24 hours
 AMBER 223 sellers	Exactly one non-dispute trigger active	Contact this week
 GREEN 143 sellers	No triggers crossed - risk elevated but stable	Monitor - check next session
 GREY All non-Persuadables	Seller is not a Persuadable	No action required

STEP 1 - THE COMMAND CENTRE - *Population overview - open first*

The Command Centre page gives a population level overview of all 3,806 sellers. Four cards at the top show the the current number of sellers and the retention rate for each segment. This allows the team know whether the population distribution has shifted at any given period. A second row of cards gives the team a summary of their workload before they open the Watchlist. It shows how many Persuadables currently require action and breaks that number down by urgency level. 147 of them are flagged as Red meaning that they requiring contact within 24 hours, 223 are flagged as Amber meaning that they need to be contacted in the current week, and 143 are flagged as Green and should be monitored. This allows the team know at a glance how to prioritise their time before they have looked at a single seller profile. Below these cards, three charts show the seller base, average churn risk, and retention rate by segment to allow the team confirm that the risk and retention profiles of each segment remain consistent with what the model was trained to produce. At the bottom, a cohort distribution chart shows how the four segments are spread across every registration quarter from 2022-Q1 to 2024-Q3. This allows the team to see whether risk is concentrated in a particular seller cohort or spread evenly across all registration periods. This is important because, it allows the team to understand if a specific onboarding period or operating environment drives an excessive share of at risk sellers.

STEP 2 - THE PERSUADABLES WATCHLIST - *Daily action list - 370 sellers requiring action*

The Persuadables watchlist shows all 513 Persuadable sellers with their current trigger status, churn risk score, tenure stage, and recommended intervention. 370 of the 513 persuadables have crossed at least one trigger and require active action. These 370 are the sellers the team must prioritize to ensure they do not churn.

Three filter buttons at the top of the page allow the team to narrow the watchlist by lifecycle stage. 64 of the 513 persuadable sellers are in the early tenure, 322 in the mid tenure, and 127 in the established tenure. Of the 370 that require action by the team, 48 of them are early tenure sellers, 230 are mid tenure sellers, and 92 are established sellers. The mid tenure stage has the most sellers compared to the rest which suggests that there is a large concentration of inactivity and logistics fault triggers in the 90 to 270 day window.

The table shows the list of sellers that require seller support with every trigger that they have crossed, their status and also the recommended action for the seller support team. This provides the team with all of the information they need to decide on what to do next for each seller.

The most common interventions across the 370 sellers that require action are logistics review (233 sellers), dispute contact within 24 hours (117 sellers), and listing quality review. The Intervention column states the specific action recommended for each seller based on their trigger profile

STEP 3 - THE TENURE TRIGGERS PAGE - *Periodic use - population-level trigger patterns*

This page shows how many sellers in the population have crossed each trigger threshold within a given lifecycle stage. It is designed to be used periodically to understand where exit risk is currently concentrating across the platform. There are three tabs that switch between Early, Mid, and Established tenure views. Each of them shows how many sellers have crossed each trigger within that stage. It allows the team to spot patterns that are worth investigating across each trigger for the entire population.

STEP 4 - INDIVIDUAL SELLER DRILL-DOWN - *Use before every seller contact - full seller profile*

The individual seller drill-down page provides the full picture for a single seller in one view and should be the last step before contacting a seller.

The top row shows the seller's segment, tenure stage, and registration cohort. Below it, three cards show the churn risk score and retention probability, the current alert status, and the number of triggers crossed out of six possible. Six trigger flag icons shows which specific thresholds are active for this seller.

The Behavioural Metrics panel shows eight metrics from the seller's 60 day observation window alongside the population average. These metrics include logins, session minutes, days since last activity, total deliveries, second half orders, disputes, logistics fault rate, and average seller score. Any metric that is very different from the population average is highlighted in red. This table allows the team understand what factors drive the seller's risk score before making contact.

The Order Trajectory panel shows the number of orders for the seller in the first 30 days versus the second 30 days of their observation window with the percentage change. A seller who received 9 orders in their first 30 days and only 6 in their second for example, shows a 30% decrease in order volume before they have even reached the end of their observation window. That downward movement in the early weeks of tenure is a clear signal that a seller's business on the platform is slowing down rather than growing.

The Seller Profile panel shows the seller's state, LGA, referral source, verification tier, and whether they operate in a category that depends on imported goods. This context matters especially when a high logistics fault rate trigger becomes active, since sellers in some states outside Lagos face infrastructure constraints that leads to faults which are not related to the sellers behaviour.

At the bottom of the page, the Recommended Action field states the specific intervention the seller support team should take. Section 6 provides the full step by step response for each scenario the team is likely to encounter.

06 Recommended Actions by Scenario

6 step-by-step response guides for the seller support team

This section translates the triggers from Section 4 into steps for the six most common situations the seller success team will encounter. Each scenario describes the sellers profile, what signal prompted the action taken, and exactly what to do. Before contacting any seller, a seller support team member should open the Individual Seller Drill-Down in the dashboard and review the sellers full profile. The recommended action field at the bottom of that page will confirm which scenario applies.

1 SCENARIO 1: NEW SELLER, NO ENGAGEMENT SIGNAL BY DAY 30

The seller registered within the last 30 days and has less than 3 logins with very little session time. The seller has not placed any order yet. No trigger would be active yet but the early pattern suggests that the low login and low session thresholds will be crossed before day 60 if nothing changes. The recommended action to take is:

- 1 Open the seller's Individual Drill-Down and review their category and registration source before making any contact.
- 2 Send a personalised message welcoming them to the platform and offering a resource that is relevant to their product category, such as a listing guide or a benchmark for prices in their category.
- 3 If there is no response or there hasn't been an increase in login activity on the platform within five days, then the action should be to escalate to a direct call.

2 SCENARIO 2: NEW SELLER, FIRST DISPUTE RECEIVED

The seller is in the early tenure and a dispute has been opened against them. This scenario makes the dispute trigger active and it makes the seller's status Red. The recommended action to take is:

- 1 The team should contact the seller within 24 hours. The 24 hour window is important because, a dispute that is left unaddressed in early tenure worsens quickly and the seller's score and listing visibility can both be affected before the team has had a chance to help.
- 2 Before contacting the seller, the support team member should open the Individual Drill-Down and check the logistics fault rate and delivery zone. If the seller is based outside Lagos in an area where there are known infrastructure challenges, the dispute may be logistics related rather than seller related. This changes how the conversation with the seller should go.
- 3 When contact is made with the seller, the support person should ask for a description of what happened before offering any guidance. By listening first, trust is established and it also provides the information needed to advise them accurately.
- 4 The next step would be to walk the seller through the dispute resolution process step by step as they may not know how it works. New sellers usually disengage from disputes because the process may be unfamiliar to them.
- 5 The seller support team member should then follow up within 48 hours to confirm the dispute has been responded to.

3 SCENARIO 3: NEW SELLER, LOW SESSION TIME AND LOW SECOND MONTH ORDERS

The seller is in early tenure and both the low session trigger and the low orders in days 30 to 60 trigger have become active at the same time making the seller's status Red. The recommended action to take is:

- 1 Open the Individual Drill-Down and check the order trajectory panel to confirm that orders declined from the first half to the second half of the observation window.
- 2 Review the seller's active listings to check if there are quality issues like having lower than three images, having a title under six words, or pricing listings far above the category average.
- 3 The seller should only be contacted when there is a specific observation and a potential solution rather than just a general check in.
- 4 If there is no improvement in login activity within 10 days, this should be flagged for escalation.

4 SCENARIO 4: MID TENURE SELLER, SUDDEN INACTIVITY AFTER AN ACTIVE PERIOD

When a seller has been active for between 90 and 270 days with a consistent prior engagement history and suddenly becomes inactive the 14 day inactivity trigger becomes active with the seller's status set to Red. The recommended action to take is:

- 1 Before contacting the seller, the support team member should, open the Individual Drill-Down and review the order trajectory and logistics fault rate. They should check whether the inactivity happened after there was a dispute or an increase in fault rate. This would suggest that there is a specific cause for the inactivity rather than a gradual withdrawal.
- 2 The next step is for the team to make direct contact with the seller by phone where possible. A seller who was previously active and has suddenly gone quiet is more likely to respond to a personal call than a written message.
- 3 The support team member should open the conversation by enquiring about their experience on the platform and asking about what has been happening with their business recently rather than referring to their absence directly. The reason for the inactivity may be not be related to the platform and the team's role is to diagnose before recommending anything.
- 4 Based on their response, the seller should be directed to the most relevant support resource.

5 SCENARIO 5: MID TENURE SELLER, HIGH LOGISTICS FAULT RATE

When a seller's logistics fault rate has crossed 0.124. The high fault rate trigger becomes active with the seller's status set to Amber or Red depending on whether any other trigger is also active. The recommended action to take is:

- 1 Before contacting the seller, the support team member should open the Individual Drill-Down and check the seller's state and LGA. A seller based outside Lagos in an area where there are infrastructure challenges should be approached with the aim of diagnosing the problem and not treated immediately as a performance issue.
- 2 The team member should then check the order trajectory panel to confirm if there is a high fault rate alongside a declining order trajectory. This is because, a combination of both is a bigger problem than just a high fault rate with stable order volume.
- 3 The seller should then be contacted and asked if they have noticed any pattern where orders have been failing to be delivered. Let them describe the situation before drawing any conclusions.
- 4 If the faults appear to be related to a courier service, the team should connect the seller with the platform's preferred logistics partner for their delivery zone.
- 5 If the faults appear to be from the seller's side, such as an incorrect address or packaging problems, the team should address the specific issue directly.
- 6 It is important that when the seller is contacted, it should not be framed as a warning or a performance review. The goal is to identify the source of the problem and help the seller fix it.

6 SCENARIO 6: PERSUADABLE SELLER, NO TRIGGERS ACTIVE

A seller that is classified as Persuadable based on their churn risk score and engagement indicator, but no trigger threshold has been crossed will have a Green status. The recommended action to take is:

- 1 This seller does not require immediate action because a Green status means that the churn risk is high but no specific trigger has been crossed yet.
- 2 The team member should check the Individual Drill-Down once a week to check whether any trigger is approaching its threshold. They should pay close attention to the login trend and order trajectory panels.
- 3 If the seller's churn risk score is above 0.80 and the order trajectory starts reducing, the team should consider checking in on the seller even without any trigger being crossed. This should be framed as a form of support rather than concern.
- 4 This seller should not be treated with the same urgency as a Red or Amber seller. This is because treating issues with this seller with any urgency wastes time the team should be spending on sellers who need it more.

-> Conclusion

Maintenance, measurement and improvement

This playbook exists because a model score on its own does not change anything for a seller who is at risk of leaving. The model identifies which sellers are at risk and which are still reachable and the playbook tells the team what to do with that information. The dashboard is an operational tool for the seller support team to manage the at risk sellers on a day to day basis.

The most important thing the team need to keep in mind is prioritisation because not every seller needs their attention and not every high risk seller will respond to an outreach. The segmentation matrix exists to solve this problem by directing time and resources towards sellers who are at risk and still active on the platform. The Persuadables Watchlist ensures the sellers that are most likely to exit without an intervention get contacted first.

Maintaining the Playbook

The triggers and segments used in this playbook were derived from three years of the platform's seller data. They reflect the conditions of selling in the Nigerian e-commerce environment that are unique to this context. These conditions however are not permanent. As the platform grows and operating conditions change, the model would need to be recalibrated with all identified thresholds reviewed. A model that was trained on one period's data will change as seller behaviour patterns evolve and retention rates shift. All thresholds that were derived from historical data will therefore lose their accuracy if the population changes. The playbook would need to be updated to reflect any changes if they occur.

Measuring Effectiveness

To measure if this playbook is working, the team must track if Persuadable sellers who received intervention have a higher retention rate than those who did not. Data that shows the trigger that led to a seller to be contacted and whether the seller is still active 90 days after should be collected daily. This provides the information necessary to improve this playbook in the future.